

OFFICIAL CONCEPT NOTE

PLATEAU STATE INNOVATION WEEK 2026

Theme

"Innovating for Sustainable Development: Empowering Northern Nigeria Through Technology, Entrepreneurship and Collaboration."

Convened By

meHub

In collaboration with

- **Plateau State Government**
- **Innovation Hubs**
- **Universities and Tertiary Institutions**
- **Technology Companies**
- **Development Partners**
- **Business Community**
- **Media Organizations**
- **Startup Ecosystem**
- **Professional Associations**

Proposed Duration

One Week

Flagship Event

Jos Innovation Hackathon 2026

Proposed Venue

University of Jos (Subject to Approval)

Proposed Date

November 2026

1. Executive Summary

Plateau State Innovation Week 2026 is a proposed week-long innovation festival designed to unite government institutions, universities, innovation hubs, technology companies, startups, development organizations, investors, media organizations, entrepreneurs, and young innovators under one collaborative platform.

The initiative seeks to strengthen Plateau State's innovation ecosystem through practical learning, technology-driven problem solving, entrepreneurship, strategic partnerships, and youth empowerment.

The flagship activity of the week will be the **Jos Innovation Hackathon 2026**, where multidisciplinary teams of students, software developers, engineers, designers, entrepreneurs, and innovators will collaborate to develop practical solutions addressing challenges in agriculture, healthcare, education, financial inclusion, climate, governance, digital services, artificial intelligence, security, and sustainable development.

Beyond the hackathon, the Innovation Week will feature keynote sessions, innovation exhibitions, startup showcases, technical workshops, career sessions, networking opportunities, policy dialogues, and mentorship programs.

The event is being coordinated by meHub using a collaborative ecosystem model in which organizations contribute according to their strengths rather than relying solely on financial sponsorship.

2. Background

Innovation has become one of the strongest drivers of economic growth worldwide. Across Africa, technology ecosystems continue to generate employment, attract investment, improve public services, and create solutions to pressing societal challenges.

Plateau State possesses tremendous innovation potential. With its respected academic institutions, emerging technology communities, growing startup ecosystem, and youthful population, the state is well positioned to become one of Northern Nigeria's leading innovation destinations.

However, many stakeholders currently operate independently, limiting opportunities for collaboration, shared learning, and collective impact.

Plateau State Innovation Week has therefore been conceived as a platform that brings together all ecosystem stakeholders to strengthen partnerships, showcase innovation, and build sustainable opportunities for young people.

3. Project Goal

To establish Plateau State as Northern Nigeria's leading innovation ecosystem by promoting collaboration among government, academia, industry, development partners, innovation hubs, and young innovators.

4. Objectives

The project aims to:

- Unite innovation stakeholders across Plateau State.
- Promote practical technology innovation.
- Encourage entrepreneurship and startup development.
- Enhance digital skills among young people.
- Strengthen collaboration between universities and industry.
- Improve engagement between government and the technology ecosystem.
- Showcase innovative solutions addressing societal challenges.
- Increase opportunities for mentorship, networking, and investment.
- Position Plateau State as a destination for innovation and technology.
- Establish an annual innovation platform for the state.

5. Why Plateau State Innovation Week?

Unlike conventional conferences or standalone hackathons, Plateau State Innovation Week adopts an ecosystem-building approach.

The initiative seeks to create lasting relationships among stakeholders while providing practical opportunities for innovation, entrepreneurship, and collaboration.

Expected long-term outcomes include:

- Increased startup creation.
- Enhanced youth employment.
- Stronger university-industry collaboration.
- Improved government engagement with innovators.
- Greater visibility for Plateau State's technology ecosystem.
- Attraction of national and international partnerships.
- Sustainable annual innovation programming.

6. Event Components

The proposed Innovation Week will consist of several integrated activities.

Jos Innovation Hackathon

A multi-day innovation competition where participants develop technology-based solutions addressing real-world challenges.

Innovation Conference

Featuring keynote speakers, government representatives, industry leaders, startup founders, and development organizations.

Technical Workshops

Hands-on sessions covering:

- Artificial Intelligence
- Software Development
- Cloud Computing
- Cybersecurity
- UI/UX Design
- Product Management
- Entrepreneurship
- Startup Growth
- Digital Marketing

Startup & Innovation Exhibition

An opportunity for startups, innovators, and technology companies to showcase products, services, and innovations.

Career & Talent Fair

Connecting students, graduates, and technology professionals with employers, recruiters, and training opportunities.

Investor & Startup Networking

A platform for innovators to engage with investors, corporate organizations, and ecosystem partners.

7. Expected Participants

The event is expected to attract participation from:

- University students.
- Software developers.

- Engineers.
- Designers.
- Entrepreneurs.
- Startup founders.
- Government agencies.
- Innovation hubs.
- Technology companies.
- Researchers.
- Investors.
- NGOs.
- Development organizations.
- Business leaders.
- Media organizations.

Expected participation:

- 300–500 participants.
- 40–60 hackathon teams.
- 30+ mentors.
- 20+ judges.
- 20+ partner organizations.

8. Expected Impact

Upon successful implementation, Plateau State Innovation Week is expected to:

- Foster collaboration among ecosystem stakeholders.
- Produce innovative technology solutions.
- Increase startup formation.
- Improve digital skills.
- Enhance youth employability.
- Strengthen public-private partnerships.
- Promote investment in innovation.
- Increase national recognition of Plateau State's innovation ecosystem.

9. Partnership Opportunities

Plateau State Innovation Week welcomes collaboration from organizations in various capacities.

Government Partners

Support through:

- Official endorsement.

- Policy dialogue.
- Publicity.
- Technical participation.
- Institutional collaboration.

Academic Partners

Support through:

- Student participation.
- Faculty mentors.
- Research presentations.
- Venue support.
- Volunteers.

Innovation Hub Partners

Support through:

- Mentorship.
- Technical expertise.
- Startup participation.
- Judges.
- Community mobilization.

Corporate Partners

Support through:

- Financial sponsorship.
- Technical resources.
- Cloud services.
- APIs.
- Workshops.
- Mentors.
- Prize sponsorship.

Business Partners

Support through:

- Catering.
- Printing.
- Branding.
- Hospitality.
- Transportation.

- Event materials.

Development Partners

Support through:

- Capacity building.
- Knowledge sharing.
- Mentorship.
- Innovation challenges.
- Youth development initiatives.
- Technical assistance.

10. Why We Are Inviting Your Organization

Your organization has been identified as a key stakeholder whose expertise, experience, network, and commitment to innovation, education, entrepreneurship, youth development, or community impact aligns with the objectives of Plateau State Innovation Week.

We believe your participation will not only strengthen the event but also contribute to building a more connected and sustainable innovation ecosystem for Plateau State.

Rather than seeking only sponsorship, we invite you to become a **Strategic Partner** in shaping the future of innovation within our state.

11. Benefits of Partnership

Partners will receive opportunities to:

- Contribute to the growth of Plateau State's innovation ecosystem.
- Engage directly with talented students and innovators.
- Showcase products, services, and programs.
- Build relationships with government, academia, and industry.
- Identify emerging talent for recruitment.
- Strengthen corporate social responsibility initiatives.
- Increase brand visibility before, during, and after the event.
- Participate in technical sessions and innovation dialogues.
- Receive recognition across event publicity and media engagements.

Partnership benefits will be tailored according to each organization's level of participation.

12. Call to Action

Plateau State possesses the talent, creativity, institutions, and entrepreneurial spirit necessary to become a leading innovation destination in Nigeria. Achieving this vision requires collaboration among all stakeholders.

We therefore invite your organization to join us as a founding strategic partner of Plateau State Innovation Week 2026.

Together, we can create opportunities for young innovators, strengthen our innovation ecosystem, and position Plateau State as a hub for technology, entrepreneurship, and sustainable development.

Contact Information

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"Innovation grows where collaboration begins."

Join us in building the future of innovation in Plateau State.